

The Florida Resilient Home Check

Florida protects homes from hurricanes. It spends nothing stopping the leak under the sink. A free, voluntary home visit that prevents water and mold claims, lowers premiums, and gives carriers a reason to come back and compete.

Prepared by **Bryan Wudarsky** · Personal-finance educator, background in insurance & banking · July 2026

1 in 4

Florida homeowners claims are caused by water

71.6%

of all U.S. homeowners insurance lawsuits are filed in Florida

96%

drop in water claims after an automatic shutoff is installed

\$30M

for a 3-year, 5-county pilot, under 10% of one year of My Safe Florida Home

The 2022–23 reforms fixed **how claims get fought**. Twenty carriers have returned and rate requests fell from ~21% to ~0.2%. But Florida premiums are still the highest in the country, because nothing touches **how many claims happen**. Premiums track expected losses. **Cut the everyday losses and the premium follows.**

THE BLIND SPOT

Every state dollar goes to wind

PERIL	STATE PROGRAM	PREMIUM CREDIT
Hurricane wind	My Safe Florida Home (\$352M)	Yes, mandatory
Flood	Federal NFIP	Separate policy
Non-weather water	None	Rarely used
Mold	None	None
HVAC & humidity	None	None

WHAT ONE LEAK BECOMES

A \$20 hose or a \$140K lawsuit

Caught at a home visit

~\$20

Water claim, closed fast

\$18,704

Drags past a year

\$63,978

Ends in litigation

\$140,055

Florida OIR, 2024 closed-claim data. Litigated claims cost ~7× more to adjust.

HOW IT WORKS

Free visit → verified device → lower premium

1

Book a free visit

Any homeowner schedules online. No income test. A trained inspector walks the home with them and checks plumbing, water heater, AC condensate line, humidity and mold risk, roof, and storm readiness.

2

Get a plan, not a sales pitch

Within 7 days: a written report, a free-fixes-today list, a 12-month maintenance calendar, and a storm checklist. Inspectors can't sell, bid on, or refer any repair work.

3

Install, verify, save

Add an automatic shutoff, leak sensors, or a condensate float switch. A verification form unlocks a premium credit, the same model wind mitigation already uses.

Credit the device, not the lecture

Florida law requires every rate to be actuarially justified, so a class alone can't earn a discount. A physical, inspectable device can. The program copies the wind-mitigation credit that already works.

WIND MITIGATION · EXISTS TODAY

- Uniform Mitigation Verification form
- Roof shape, straps, opening protection
- Carrier must discount the wind premium
- Fla. Stat. 627.0629 & 627.711



WATER MITIGATION · PROPOSED

- New Uniform Water Mitigation form
- Auto shutoff, leak sensors, steel lines, float switch
- Carrier must discount the water premium
- New parallel subsection of 627.0629

THE RETURN

Pays for itself at under 1% of homes

\$25M

per year, full statewide program (100,000 visits)

~830

avoided claims to break even, under 1% of homes visited

~1,400

water claims prevented per year at maturity

\$41.6M

losses avoided per year at Florida claim costs

Modeled conservatively, at half the effect the studies measured. Not counted: smaller claims, avoided lawsuits, and the per-family premium dividend.

THE EVIDENCE

Prevention already pays

96%

fewer water claims and 72% smaller ones after automatic shutoff
LexisNexis Risk Solutions, 2,306-home matched study

\$4K

smaller average claim with leak sensors; ~93% of leaks caught
Nationwide & Resideo, 2025

22%

median insurance savings, about \$1,250 a year per home
Louisiana Legislative Auditor, Fortify Homes (wind)

35%

wind premium cuts across 50,000+ hardened homes
Strengthen Alabama Homes (wind)

BUILT-IN PROTECTIONS

Families will only open the door if it's safe to

Findings firewall

The report belongs to the homeowner. Insurers can't see it or act on it.

No code enforcement

No citations, no referrals to a building department.

No sales

Inspectors can't sell or refer any work.

No new agency

Runs on DFS's inspector roster and UF/IFAS in all 67 counties.

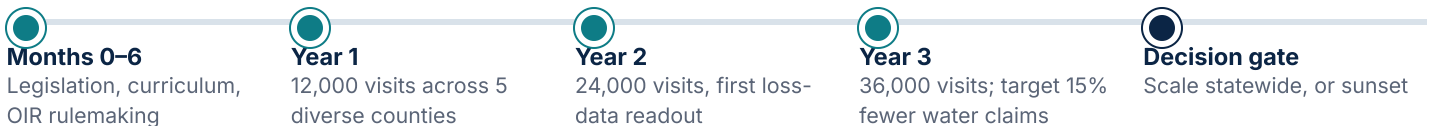
Kill switch

No measurable claim drop in 3 years means it doesn't scale.

THE PILOT

Three years, five counties, one controlled study

Hillsborough · Miami-Dade · Escambia · Marion · Lee, measured against a matched control group



The ask

1. **Publish the data.** Direct DFS and OIR to release Florida water and mold loss data within 90 days.
2. **Fund the pilot.** About \$10M a year for three years in the next General Appropriations Act.
3. **Build the credit now.** OIR starts rulemaking on the water-mitigation form so it's ready when the data lands.